

Friendship Circle

Sensitivity Training



Contract

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The Situation

The Rebbe wrote, "Anyone dealing with retarded individuals should start from the basic premise that the retardation is in each case only temporary, and that in due course, it could certainly be improved, and even improved substantially. This approach should be taken regardless of the pronouncements or prognosis of specialists in the field. The reason for this approach is, first of all, that it is a precondition for greater success in dealing with the handicapped." We believe the Rebbe's words apply to dealing with handicaps of any kind in children. And that today's teenagers have as much to gain as to give when working with handicapped children or teens.

Right now Friendship Circle is bringing their recruitment meetings into a room of 50--75 teenagers many of which are only there because it is a reason to get out of class. We are not dealing with an audience of people that have already volunteered. We are usually dealing with a captive audience that is there because they have to be. With such a high level of forced choice with the participants, you run the risk of bombing out simply because there is a strong possibility that many will not participate. In many cases, because they do not really "get" the value of the commitment.

We want each teenager to leave with a positive experience even if they do not "sign up" as a volunteer.

The Presentation Concept

The purpose of The Friendship Circle Recruitment Presentation is to provide the rabbis who initiate this program with a highly experiential format that will engage the whole person - body and soul. We can make the learning very deep while having it appear simple.

While the course content has yet to be developed, here is the preliminary outline for the presentation:

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Opening 5 minutes

Rabbi sets a context of openness by how he interacts from the outset.

He starts with a discussion about the eyes of a teenager and what they are able to perceive. And that parents in general have lost the ability to perceive in the same way. He demonstrates this with provocative questions and information.

Video 5 minutes

We show the existing video. We give out the words of the song that is on the video so that the students can follow.

- After the slide show, we ask the participants to turn to person next to them and share what they saw. We emphasize the word "saw".
- We can also ask the large group to answer the same question and address the answer to the front of the room.
- We can ask a volunteer to write on a flip chart so that the Rabbi can face the audience while the answers are being written.

Activity 5 minutes

Rabbi asks the class to list the things they love to do and the things they can't stand to do. He captures the ideas all on a flipchart.

Debrief 5 minutes

Then he leads the class in getting down to the core of what they love (being with friends) and the core of what they can't stand (being isolated and without friends.)

- He leads the discussion to talking about their hopes, dreams and fears. They are all very similar.
- The point is then made that these dreams and hopes are the same as any person, handicapped or not.

Wrap-up 5 minutes

The rabbi leads a discussion of

- When do they feel the best about themselves (*when giving*)
- What do they see as their responsibility in creating the world a better place (*giving, speaking up against*)

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inequities, taking stands, etc.

- The likeness in what they hate and like
- The likeness in their hopes, fears and dreams
- What action will they choose to take to make other teens or children not feel alone? And, what does that mean to them?
- What does commitment mean? *They have a handout to take away from the program, a poem on commitment that was written during a mountain climbing expedition. It is signed by the presenter and is on parchment like paper.*

After we end. This is approximately 25 to 30 minutes.

Additional Options

We will create an additional activity for use whenever time is expanded. This activity will take 20 minutes.

Being Disabled exercise - we ask them to imagine themselves learning that they have just become disabled. How will they live their life differently? What are their needs now? This activity gives them a chance to look at what is important to them.

We also propose two activities that could be used after the volunteers have signed up to help prepare them for the actual experience:

The Gloves of Arthritis - we have them put on soaped over glasses, foam earplugs and rubber gloves with the fingers stuffed with Popsicle sticks and cotton. Then we ask them to try to button a shirt or dial a phone. The intent is to give them an experience of being disabled so that they will have empathy for the disabled.

The Hitchhiker (role play) - they are asked to envision being on a road trip with their parents and in the near distance a hitchhiker appears with a dog. The parents see a potentially dangerous, scruffy person to be avoided. They see a fellow human in need that is obviously trustworthy because his dog is well cared for. How do they resolve the discrepancy in perception and convince the parents to give the hitchhiker a chance?

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Facilitator Training

The Friendship Circle Recruitment Presentation requires a facilitator who is able to:

- Tolerate how they feel while conflict is going on
- Allow for discovery on the participants' part
- Accept participants questioning what they themselves may never have questioned
- Create a safe and compassionate environment for people who are wrestling with emotions.

Deliverables

The project deliverables include the following:

- Recruitment program.
- All presentation materials.
- Train-the-Trainer program for the presenters.

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Assumptions

1. We will conduct interviews with
 - Jewish Teenagers in Colorado to see what can motivate them to want to do this form of volunteering and to see what music they listen to
 - Teens that are already in Friendship Circles to see why they did it, what the experience is like and what it means to them.
 - Disabled children who are in the program and those who are not.
 - Parents of disabled children who are in the program
2. We will incorporate the findings into the design of the program.
3. We will initially use the existing video.
4. The expenses incurred in the creation of the program, and materials as well as travel expenses are additional. (Will get estimate)
5. Judith will train the presenter rabbis in how to set context and conduct debriefs to get the desired response.

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Investment

The project cost as defined herein is \$5,000 for design and development of program and one day of facilitator training payable as follows:

- One half upon signing contract
- One quarter upon completion of materials
- One quarter upon completion of facilitator training if done in June at meeting. Otherwise, an agreed upon time between both parties. Our expectation is to have the program completed before your June conference.

In addition, Orloff Consulting will initially be paid \$500 to \$1,000 per center to use program, depending on size for the first 10 centers to sign on. After the first ten, the cost will be \$750 to \$1500 per center to use program, depending on size.

Hard cost expenses such as graphic design, printing, and materials, travel, etc. are additional.

Should Friendship Circle require additional training beyond that provided the Coaching Session under this Agreement may charge additional fees.

In addition to the provisions of this Agreement, should Friendship Circle ask for changes to the seminar not originally contemplated by this contract, the timetable or any other materials, etc., additional fees may be charged for these "Change Orders." Fees and costs resulting from Change Orders to the seminar will be negotiated as needed.

Time Line

	Phase	Events & Deliverables	Duration	Timeline
1	Research	We will gather the contextual information, and issues.	2 weeks	Early May
2	Design	Core content, learning objectives and activities, for client approval.	2 weeks	Late May
3	Development	We develop Instructor materials, Graphics, and	2 weeks	Early June